

8 Steps to an In-House Client Presentation

Step 1- Get your mind right. Attitude can make the difference between success and failure. Before you step out of the car and go up to your client's door, compartmentalize everything going on in your life. Put it all to the side. Focus on the appointment you are about to begin. Take a minute and visualize everything you want to have happen while you are sitting with your client. Visualize all the successful things you want to accomplish; like making a positive connection with the client and successfully going over their financial inventory. Go over in your head what you are going to cover in this appointment. Step 1 is seeing how each of these eight steps will play out with your client before you enter the appointment. This is very important! If you do not have your mind right, the rest of this won't matter. You might go through your presentation and say all the right words, but it's how you say those words that can make the difference. In addition, it's how your clients hear what you are saying and that is a direct result on you having your mind right. Getting your mind right before every appointment is vital to your meeting with your clients.

Step 2- Tell them who you are and what you do. Tell your clients a little bit about who you are and what you do. Let them know about you family, where you grew up, etc. This helps your clients build a connection and build trust with you. Include in this conversation that you are an independent field underwriter which means you are not tied to a particular insurance company. Being independent allows you to find the best solutions for your clients because each client's situation is unique and different. Let them know you have been able to help your clients because you work with many carriers like, CVS, Amerigo, Mutual of Omaha, and Transamerica just to name a few. You have done the shopping for them. Tell them you consider many carriers because each client's situation is different. Having access to all the different carriers allows you to do what is best for your client. Let them know you look at a client's age, smoking status, sex and health to determine which carrier is best for them.

As you are in that conversation you will also want to say, "the other thing that comes up Bob & Mary (use their first name if you can) with many of the people I work with is the cost. My clients know they need life insurance, they want it, but they are concerned they cannot afford it. The good news is because these are state approved whole life plans and I am independent, I work with many different carriers to get a plan that fits the client's needs and stays within their budget.

Now as an agent, you may be asking yourself why I should do all of that. You should do it because sharing insight about you and your role with your clients helps paint the picture that you help the clients you meet with. You want the clients to hear that a lot of people are doing this, and you are out here doing what's best for the client. An agent shares this information with their clients because people tend to do what others are doing, and so they will want to do what everybody else is doing. Saying all of that and going through that infers ...This is a good thing to do, and it would be weird if you didn't help them too. The other objection you overcome with this type of conversation is the "I can't afford it" objection. If you don't overcome that right at the beginning, it won't matter what else I say because they will always be thinking, they cannot afford it. Let them know they are not alone, and other clients were thinking that too. Let them know you were able to help them and stay within their budget. Others had a fixed income, maybe like you have, and I was able to help them. I am sure I can help you too and stay within your budget.

You tear down these walls they may have built up in their mind. I want them to feel like we are in this together and I am there to serve and help them. I do not want to get emotional when clients are asking a question. I want to respond in such a way that helps the client realize I am there to help them. I want to develop a vulnerability between the client and myself. If people like you, they will listen to you but when they trust you, they will do business with you.

Step 3 - A little known fact and why final expense. Presenting these facts to the client helps open their eyes to the cost of final expense. It is also important to let the client know that many of the clients you work with and were able to help fall into the 40% category of people who didn't have enough insurance. Yet, you were able to help them to get the protection they needed within a price they could afford.

Let them know what SS would pay (SS pays \$255 first to die) and if they are a veteran what the VA would pay (VA pays \$1500 only if they qualify). Letting them know that upfront addresses the objection one of those organizations would pay for a funeral. It helps build the need for them having a final expense plan. You are starting to bring in the emotion of the sale into your presentation and painting a picture for the client to see the need.

Step 4 –Who are they? What final expense can do and Establishing the need. What is their why?

Questions are the key in this step. Ask them about themselves and their family. Have **they** lost a loved one? Are their parents alive? In either case, were you involved in planning the funeral? If so, was a plan in place? Do they remember how much the funeral they planned cost? How long ago was that? Why did they respond to a lead? Why did they make an inquiry? Tell me about their current life insurance program? Also, let them know why final expense and what it does.

This is a time to possibly share stories about the clients you have helped. (a story to share, many of my clients realized they didn't have a plan in place but really did not know how to take care of it. I was able to help them and stay within a budget they could afford) I also advise them that many people that I have helped there are three main reasons that are important to them and always come up when thinking about covering their final expenses, and not leaving that burden to someone else. Lets review each of the top three.

The first one is, clients want to make sure that all their final expenses are taken care of and not left to a family member to figure out how will they pay for it. They do not want to leave a financial burden to their loved ones. I would say, the last thing people want to think about when they wake up the next morning and realize that a loved one is gone. How to pay for those final expenses. With the average cost of a funeral over \$12,000 and if you add family expenses it can be over \$18,000. The last thing they want to think about is how am I going to pay for all those final expenses. They do not want to have to ask themselves what do I do? What they want to know is, that these final expenses are taken care of. They do not want to have to figure out how to set up a "go-fund-me" account because there is no money to pay for these expenses. By the way go-fund me accounts are taxable and most go-fund me accounts get less than \$5,000. The number one reason people get protection is to know when they pass away the burial expense are taken care of and not left to a loved one. Does that make sense to you?

The second reason people want final expense protection is income replacement. This is a big reason too because people realize their income will go down with the death of a spouse. For example, when a

spouse passes away that SS check or pension gets reduced or goes away; they will have to adjust their budget. The last thing they want to think about is how to adjust their budget to get by each month and how those final expenses will get paid. They do not want to have to figure all that out. They want to be able to mourn, grieve and to move forward in a healthy and less stressful way. Many people get life insurance to replace income for a period of time; such as a year, six months, or two years. They want to bridge that gap. Does that make sense to you?

The third reason people consider final expense protection is they want to leave a legacy. When they pass away, they want to leave something to their children, grandkids or possibly help pay for college. Sometimes they want to leave something to a church or an organization they belonged to. They consider if they can leave some money that is tax free as part of their legacy, why not do that. Does that make sense to you?

Then I state; Those are the three main reasons others consider getting final expense protection. For you, is it more about covering the final expenses, the income replacement or leveraging your legacy? Which one is most important to you? Then let them answer; be silent.

When you ask that question, ask it in such a way that indicates these are important points. They should realize these are all very important, but you want to know which one is most important to them. By you doing this, you are providing them options to consider. You are helping them identify which is most important to them. As you notice in my presentation, you are identifying why they need this protection right after I just overcame any objections they may have had. This will help them put their guard down as I bring up the three reasons why people consider buying final expense protection. Be sure Not to miss this! When pointing out the three reasons, you are not just stating them. You are painting a picture for them on each one. I am painting a picture of what it is going to be like when one of them passes away. I will also say, Bob and Mary one thing is almost a guarantee and that is that one of you will be here without the other. It is a very small likelihood of something happening to the both of you at the same time. I am painting that picture as I go to help them realize they do need this protection.

Step 5- Three things I want to accomplish. You let the clients know these are the things I want to accomplish in this meeting. By now, they have identified what is important to them; final expense, replaced income and or leaving a legacy. The three things I want to accomplish are all very simple. My number one goal is to make sure the plan we choose is something that you can absolutely afford. Not just afford it for one month but you are able to sustain it. Because if the plan is not there when something happens, the value of it is also gone, leaving no value for anyone. I want to make sure its sustainable because it is that important. Does that make sense?

The second thing I want to accomplish is to make sure you qualify. I work with many great companies like United of Omaha, Aetna and Transamerica to name a few. You look like you are in great health but we want to make sure we can get you the best coverage at the price in which you can afford. I also want to make sure this will be in place when you need it most other wise we are losing the value of what we are doing today. Let the client know you will work with them because they do need to qualify for the protection we are looking at and stay within your budget, because it's that important. Does that make sense.

The third thing I want to accomplish is to make sure my clients understand it. At the end of the day this is the most important thing that my clients will have this in place for their family. When something

happens to them, they will know exactly how this will look when they are gone. How the policy works needs to be clear so they don't end up being the client who says oh we've got this, then something happens and the beneficiary learns what they had was accidental insurance and the person didn't pass away from an accident. As a result, there is no death benefit. I want to make sure you know exactly what will be in place. I will ask them, "Does that make sense?". We must accomplish these things, because it's that important to you and your loved ones. Does that make sense? I ask those questions because I want them to be agreeing with me throughout the presentation.

Step 6- Go over the process. Advise them the process is simple. You want to find a plan that is a good fit for the client. We will consider the amount they need and then, by answering a number of health questions, determine which policy is best for them. You cannot make the decision for the company. But it is that important that we find a plan that fits their needs. We will send in the request for coverage to the insurance company and they come back with a yes or a no. If they say no, not to worry; that happens sometimes because we are going for the lowest risk available. You have got my word that we will find a plan you qualify for and be within your budget. Once we find out you qualify, we have 30 days to make any adjustment if necessary. That is the process we are going to use. Does that make sense?

This lets the clients know what the process is and now I would walk them through each step of that process that you just articulated.

Step 7- The needs and financial Inventory – This step is a big one. The financial Inventory is crucial! This is where you add additional color to the picture. When I talk to agents who are struggling in the homes typically it's because they are not going through every question in the fact finder to obtain the financial inventory of the clients to determine a clear need. If you do not go through the fact finder with every client, you are definitely missing out on thousands of dollars each month, money you are leaving on the table for other opportunities. The fact finder and financial inventory is the information you need to truly help your clients. Every one of the questions is painting a picture, ask them about their income, what kind of life insurance do they have. If they say they have life insurance have them go, get the policy out. You will be able to see how they underwrote the policy, and you can also evaluate what kind of policy it is to see what options might be available to help them. All those questions help paint the picture for the client. Ask what they have in place that acts like life insurance when you pass away that will be income replacement. What does that look like? Make sure to ask the health questions to because by doing so brings the client mortality into the equation. They will start to see well maybe I am not the healthiest person out there. They have stuff going on. Ask them if they have a mortgage and what it is. You want to know that because you may need to look at covering that expense too. The fact finder/financial inventory is absolutely critical. You've got to go through it.

Now this is where your close ratio will go through the roof! This is where you will protect almost every client you meet with. As the agent, you say to your clients, Bob when you pass away, don't say if you pass away but rather state "when you pass away" that income you bring in will most likely drop or go away. Mary, what does that look like for you financially, as far as you being able to pay all the bills and taking care of everything when Bob doesn't come home or he is no longer here. What does that look like on how you will cover the day-to-day or month-to-month expenses? How will you pay those bills?

As the agent, you must ask those questions with sincerity. This is not a time to come across manipulative or flippant. They should see and hear the sincerity in your voice and body language. Be sincere when talking about what this looks like. State, "Here's your situation, realize each situation is

different but for you how does this impact you?" After you ask how this will look and impact you...remain silent. Every second they do not respond is good. Every second they are in silence they are living in the picture you just painted for them. The more they live in that silence the greater the value becomes of what you said, the more they realize they need it, the more emotional they become. I am telling you emotion drives motion. People make decisions almost 100% time on emotion and then they try to find the logical reason to support their emotional decision. That is why you must make this sale an emotional sale and a logical sale. One without the other is not good. If they make an emotional decision and buy something, they cannot afford there is no logic behind that, and they will cancel. The sale must be both emotional and logical. Those questions make a difference. How will this impact you? How does this look for you those kinds of question make a big difference? At first it will be uncomfortable for you, the more you do it, it will become second nature to you. You owe to your clients and to yourself to get comfortable being uncomfortable with your clients. If you do not, you will not be able to help your clients like you should. If you do not ask the right questions, if you do not let them live in silence when you ask the right question...the more you do the better you will become!

Step 8 – Quoting/close, now that I have an idea of what their income is, what their expenses are and their need...I can provide them options. The final expense worksheet will help you do just that with your clients. It will guide you and your clients into the three-option close. Whether they want to cover the funeral expenses, family expenses, or the total estimated final expenses. Ask, "So Bob and Mary, based on your budget and your expenses as we went through you plan Your funeral expense were_____ your family expenses were _____ and your total final expense were _____in order to make the burden of your final expenses are taken care and not left to your loved one which ones best meets your budget? Remain silent...let them answer.

(when I know the amount of each expense before I ask the close question I am letting them see the monthly cost of each expense, then go into the close statement)

Whichever they decide on, I am going right into the assumptive close and begin filling out the application. Ask them to get their Driver's License and complete the application.

Step 9, Ask for referrals

The most common reason for not getting referrals, is not asking. The best technique for getting referrals is by asking questions, not asking for referrals.

Who do you know?

- Recently retired.
- Recently married.
- Moved to the area.
- Bought a new home.
- Had a new child or grandchild.
- Approaching retirement.
- Would welcome a visit like this to explore their needs and consider options?
- Recently bought or change Medicare plans.

If you use Legacy Safeguard and sign them up ask for referrals like this. We believe that part of leaving a lasting legacy is helping others leave one too. Now that you are a member of Legacy Safegaurd you can sponsor up to six people to receive the same great benefits you just received at no cost. Who might you know who would like to leave a lasting legacy to their loved ones?

Those are the 8 steps of a successful final expense presentation.

1. Get your mind right.
2. Tell them who you are and what you do.
3. Who are they? Start identifying the need.
4. Three things you want to accomplish in this meeting.
5. The process.
6. The needs and financial analysis.
7. Application, quote, give them options.
8. Referrals.